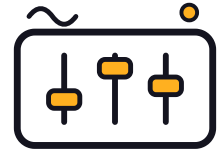


THE TASK BOARD LESSON • LESSON 5 OF 6

Robots Do the Boring Work



A 45-minute AI-and-future-jobs lesson. The hook: your class runs Big Dream Studio, a small recording studio with too much to do. They decide which tasks go to AI, which get AI's help, and which stay fully human — and they own the tradeoff behind every call.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Studio Task Board worksheet (1 per student)	None — fully unplugged by design	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Students can sort real job tasks into **automate**, **augment**, and **keep human** — and explain the difference.
- Students can compare the tradeoffs of an automation choice: who wins, who loses, what could go wrong.
- Students can defend a sorting decision aloud with a clear claim and specific supporting details.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS ELA SL.6.4

ISTE 1.3.d

Full standards text, with where each is taught and assessed, in the Teacher Guide.

🔌 WARM-UP — THE MOST BORING JOB EVER (7 MIN)

Ask: **"What's the most boring job you can think of?"** Take 4–5 answers and write them on the board. Then pick two or three and ask the follow-up:

"Is it boring because it REPEATS — same thing, over and over, no decisions? Or is it 'boring' but secretly full of people stuff — helping, noticing, talking someone down?"

Sort them as a class: repeats → robot bait. People stuff → hold on to it. (A toll booth job repeats — but the toll collector also waves at every regular. Let students argue; the arguing is the point.)

Bridge: "Here's the honest version, no robot apocalypse: nobody knows exactly which jobs change. What we can see already: The boring, repeating parts get automated; the human parts become the job. But every time a business automates something, somebody wins, somebody loses, and something could go wrong. Today YOU make those calls — for a recording studio."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — THREE COLUMNS, ONE LENS (10 MIN)

Draw three columns on the board and define them:

AUTOMATE — boring and repeating. No judgment calls. Hand it to AI.

AUGMENT — a human makes the call, AI helps out.

KEEP HUMAN — coaching, taste, being there for someone. The human IS the product.

Then model the **tradeoff lens** on one studio task (with students, call it "the trade"). Task: "Send the 'don't forget your session' texts." Column: AUTOMATE — but don't stop there:

WHO WINS?	WHO LOSES SOMETHING?	WHAT COULD GO WRONG?
Jaylen — gets hours back for actual clients.	Jaylen, a little — sending those texts is how he learned every client's name.	A cheerful reminder lands after a canceled session.

Say it plainly: "The column is the easy part. The trade is the real thinking. In this room, 'because robots' is not a reason. 'Who wins, who loses, what could go wrong' — that's a reason."

MAIN ACTIVITY — THE STUDIO TASK BOARD (15 MIN)

- Sort (8 min):** Pairs sort tasks A–L into the three columns. House rule: every column gets at least two tasks. Partners who disagree talk it out; either can be right.
- Trade cards (7 min):** Each pair picks TWO of their calls and writes the trade — who wins, who loses, what could go wrong (worksheet p.2, which introduces the word "tradeoff" once, kid-plain).

SHARE-OUT — DEFEND THE BOARD (8 MIN)

Teach the delivery first (1 min): "Three moves: eyes up off the page, voice to the back wall, slow down on your claim." **Pairs of pairs (4 min):** two pairs face each other. Each pair defends ONE choice in 30 seconds with the worksheet claim frame — "Task ___ belongs in ___ because ___ — and the trade is ___." — and the listening pair answers with one keep and one fix. You circulate with the Defense Rubric (Teacher Guide p.2).

Whole class (3 min): four or five pairs bring their most-argued call to the room. **Gallery-walk variant:** post the boards and tour for 2 minutes instead of the whole-class round.

EXIT TICKET (5 MIN)

Bottom of worksheet p.2: students run the three columns on **a job someone in their life actually has** — one line per column, plus a why for the human one.

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Sort 8 tasks instead of 12 (skip B, F, J, L); column definitions and the claim frame are printed on the worksheet.
- Extension:** Find one task where automating saves money now but hurts the studio in a year — explain the chain.
- ELL:** Sorting letters keeps the writing load low; the claim frame doubles as a language frame; pairs may argue in their strongest language, then present in English.
- No-device classrooms:** Built in — the entire lesson runs on paper and talk.